

Day 7 — The Policy Debate: Should IKS Be Integrated into Mainstream Education?

Module: What is IKS? (Senior) · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

Students articulate and defend a position on NEP 2020 §4.6 (IKS integration) with citation and counter-argument.

Materials

- NEP 2020 §4.6 printed extract
- Whiteboard

Flow

Warm-up (3 min)

Brief framing: today is structured debate. Three positions on the table.

Three positions (5 min)

Position	One-line claim	Scholarly defender (typical)
A — Integration	IKS should be taught alongside modern science in mainstream curriculum.	Kapil Kapoor; some NEP authors
B — Separation	IKS belongs in humanities/history class; modern science class should focus on the scientific method.	Romila Thapar; Ramachandra Guha (broadly)
C — Qualified integration	Historical context yes; equivalent scientific validity no.	Manjul Bhargava—style “math is universal”

Debate (25 min)

- 5 min: groups by position (self-select; balance).
- 8 min: group prep — 2 strongest arguments + 1 steel-manned counter to each of the other two.
- 10 min: structured debate (3 min per group + 1 min cross).
- 2 min: closing.

Oral assessment (during)

Teacher scores 5 random students on: position clarity, evidence use, counter-argument steel-manning, listening.

Wrap-up (12 min)

- 3 students share if their view shifted.
- *“You don’t have to commit tonight. Your paper position can be different from your debate position. That’s intellectually honest.”*

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Take a position you DON’T hold. Hardest form of argument.
- **Tier down:** Use Day 5 reading response as your script.

Teacher notes

- This is the most politically charged session. Honour the discomfort.
- The honest framing: each position has a strongest version. The skill is articulating all three.

Citation(s) used

- NEP 2020 §4.6.
- Thapar (2014).
- Various Kapil Kapoor writings.